

Sticky Toffee Pudding (Variation 10)

Tags: *dessert, british, baking, comfort-food, winter* | Prep: 25 min | Cook: 35 min | Serves: 4

Ingredients

- Sponge: 100 g pitted Medjool dates, 250 ml boiling water, 1 tsp bicarbonate of soda, 70 g butter softened, 170 g light brown sugar, 2 large eggs, 175 g all-purpose flour, 1 tsp baking powder, 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Toffee sauce: 100 g light brown sugar, 150 ml heavy cream, 80 g butter, pinch of salt, 1 tsp vanilla extract
- Vanilla ice cream or clotted cream to serve

Method

1. Preheat oven to 180 °C. Grease a 23 cm square baking tin.
2. Place dates and bicarbonate of soda in a bowl. Pour over boiling water. Leave for 10 minutes until soft, then mash or blend to a coarse paste.
3. Beat butter and sugar until light and fluffy. Beat in eggs one at a time.
4. Fold in flour and baking powder. Stir in date paste and vanilla.
5. Pour into prepared tin. Bake for 30–35 minutes until a skewer comes out clean.
6. For toffee sauce: combine all ingredients in a saucepan over medium heat. Stir until sugar dissolves. Simmer for 5 minutes until thick and glossy.
7. Pour half the warm toffee sauce over the hot sponge. Let it soak in for 5 minutes.
8. Cut into portions and serve with remaining warm sauce and vanilla ice cream.

Chef Tips

- The date paste is what makes the pudding moist and sticky — it disappears into the sponge.
- Pour toffee sauce over the sponge while both are hot for maximum absorption.
- Leftovers reheat brilliantly — warm in microwave with extra sauce.